

CORE FORMULA

Point -> Reason -> Example -> Point -> My point is X. The reason is Y. For example, Z. So the short answer is X. -> Point: lead with the one thing that matters. -> Reason: give the single strongest why, not every why. -> Example: make it concrete with one case, not three. -> Best field rule: use the structure to organise thought, then speak like a person.

MINIMUM VIABLE MOVE

State your point in one sentence, give one reason, offer one concrete example, then land back on the point — without ever naming the framework.

BEST FOR

- Concise recommendations
- Explaining a decision or your reasoning
- Meeting contributions
- Interview answers
- Making a scannable point in an email
- Answering "what do you think?" without rambling

PHRASE BANK

Quick openers · One-line starters

- "Short version?"
- "My point is this."
- "Here's the one thing that matters."
- "Bottom line first, then the why."
- "Let me keep this to a sentence."
- "One point, one reason, one example."
- "The headline is X."
- "Quick answer: X. Want the reasoning?"

Meetings & recommendations · Work contexts

- "My recommendation is X. The reason is Y. For example, Z. So my vote is X."
- "The point is we should move the deadline. Testing isn't ready — staging failed twice this week. So I'd push it a week."
- "In short, I'd go with option B: it's cheaper to run, and the March trial proved that out."
- "My read is we're aligned on scope, just not on timing."
- "One point for the record: the risk sits in the handover, not the build."
- "Here's my answer, the reason behind it, and one example — then I'll stop."
- "I'll give you a recommendation and a reason, and leave the decision with you."
- "The main point is X; everything else is just support for it."

Clear point, clear ask · Firm and plain

- "My point is I can't take this on this week."
- "Short answer: no. Here's the one reason why."
- "Let me give you the point before the detail."
- "Here's what I think, and the single reason I think it."
- "I'll make the point once, clearly, then it's yours."
- "The point stands on one example — here it is."

- "That's my position. Reason and example if you want them."

Collaborative framing · Open and easy

- "Can I give you the short version, then fill in whatever's useful?"
- "I'll keep this simple and we can dig into any part of it."
- "Here's where I've landed — tell me if I've missed something."
- "Let me lay it out plainly, then it's over to you."
- "I want to be clear, not to lecture — pull me up if I overdo it."
- "Short and rough first, then we refine it together."

When it lands as a speech · Soften and simplify

- "I made that too structured — let me say it more simply."
- "That came out like a mini-speech. The real point is just X."
- "Let me back up — I don't think that was the useful frame."
- "I don't want the structure to bury the actual issue."
- "Which part of that was useful, and what should we drop?"
- "Sorry, I over-explained. Short version: X."

Under pressure · Check before you structure

- "Before I lay this out — is now the moment, or do you need something else first?"
- "I can give you the clean version, but say if you'd rather just talk it through."
- "Let me check this frame is useful before I run with it."
- "I'll make one point and stop, because I know this matters."
- "If the tidy answer feels cold here, tell me and I'll drop it."
- "One point, then I'll listen — I don't want to talk over this."

WEAK -> BETTER -> BEST

1. Weak: Recites PREP as a visible script and sounds rehearsed.
Better: Uses PREP silently to organise a concise response.
Best: Uses PREP flexibly, then checks whether the listener is clearer, more heard, or better able to respond.
2. Weak: Announces "I'll use PREP here" out loud.
Better: Drops the label and just makes the point cleanly.
Best: Structure is invisible; it sounds like a clear person thinking well.
3. Weak: Piles on three examples and loses the point.
Better: Gives one example that fits.
Best: Picks the single example that makes the point land, then returns to it.

DECISION TREE

If The listener needs speed

Use the shortest version — the point alone, BLUF-level brevity.

"Short answer: move it a week. Detail if you want it."

If The listener needs convincing

Use the full Point -> Reason -> Example -> Point.

"Move it a week — testing's behind, staging failed twice. So a week."

If The listener needs support

Validate first and delay the framework.

"This deadline's brutal, I know. Can I say what I think we do?"

If The listener needs a story

Switch to an example-led neighbour such as STAR or CARL.

"Let me walk you through what actually happened last time."

If The listener needs action

End with one clean next step.

"So the next step is: re-test payments today, hold the date."

SCENARIOS

Work meeting

Make your contribution concise and memorable — one point, one reason, one example, then hand back. — "I'd hold the date. The risk is only in payments, and we can re-test that today."

Email

Put the framework into short, scannable paragraphs or bullets so the reader gets the point on first pass. — "Recommendation: push a week. Reason: testing's behind. Example: staging failed twice. Net: a week."

Giving feedback

Check what kind of feedback would help before you structure it — don't lead with a tidy framework into an open wound. — "Want the quick version or the full picture? Either's fine."

Difficult conversation

Use one sentence per step, then pause. Let the structure hold you steady without turning it into a wall. — "My point is I need to change how we split this. Here's why, then I'll stop."

Interview answer

Answer the question, give your reason, offer one concrete example, then close on the answer — don't drift. — "Yes. My strength is untangling messy problems — for instance, the migration last year — so that's where I'd add value."

Quick update to a busy manager

Lead with the point and the one thing they need to know; skip the build-up entirely. — "We're on track bar one risk — payments testing — and I've got a plan for it."

WHEN NOT TO USE

- High-emotion moments
- Active conflict
- Exploratory listening, where you should be drawing them out
- When the other person needs validation first
- Sensitive material — shame, grief, anger or distress
- Real power imbalance or a high-stakes decision, where care matters more than tidiness
- When physical safety or an immediate emergency takes priority

7-DAY PRACTICE DRILL

Day 1 — Draft it

Take a real topic and write a 60-second answer using Point -> Reason -> Example -> Point.

Day 2 — Cut it

Trim yesterday's answer by a third without losing the core point.

Day 3 — Say it two ways

Read it aloud once as visible structure, once as plain speech — and keep the plain one.

Day 4 — Strip the labels

Remove any "my point is / the reason is / for example" scaffolding and check it still holds together.

Day 5 — One example only

Swap in the single strongest example and delete every other one.

Day 6 — Use it live

Use it once in a real conversation and watch whether the listener actually gets clearer.

Day 7 — Practise the recovery

Rehearse one recovery line for when it lands as a mini-speech — and use it if it does.

AFTER-ACTION CHECKLIST

- Did I use PREP to serve the listener, not to sound polished?
- Was the core point clear in one sentence?
- Did I keep it concise?

- Did I adapt when the listener needed something else?
- Did I preserve their autonomy and dignity?
- Did clarity actually improve, or did I just sound tidy?